

Lesson 13

Case Study: Delegating Tasks



Warm-Up

1. Share an experience when you failed to delegate tasks to others. What happened? How did you solve it?
2. How did you decide who to delegate to, and how did you communicate the tasks and expectations?
3. What challenges did you face, and how did you overcome them?
4. What was the outcome, and what did you learn from the experience?





Case Study

At TechCorp, a software development company, Project Manager Rachel is tasked with delivering a complex software project within a tight deadline. To achieve this, she delegates tasks to her team of developers, designers, and quality assurance specialists. Rachel assigned tasks based on individual strengths. This delegation enables the team to work efficiently, leveraging each member's expertise to meet the project's technical requirements.

However, Rachel's delegation approach has some limitations. She doesn't provide clear instructions on the project's technical specifications, leading to miscommunication and delays. Additionally, she doesn't establish a clear communication plan, resulting in team members working in silos and potential issues unnoticed.

To improve her delegation, Rachel should provide detailed technical briefings, establish regular team meetings and progress updates, and encourage open communication among team members. By doing so, Rachel can ensure that her team delivers a high-quality software product on time, meeting the client's expectations and enhancing TechCorp's reputation.

Case Study Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What are the benefits and drawbacks of Rachel's delegation approach?
2. What role does clear communication play in effective task delegation?
3. How can team members contribute to the delegation process to ensure their needs are met?
4. How can project managers balance the need for control with the benefits of delegating tasks to team members?
5. What strategies can be implemented to ensure that team members are working collaboratively and addressing potential issues promptly?



Practice

ACTIVITY 1: FILL IN BLANKS

Instructions: To have effective delegation skills, consider the following tips using the words from the provided list that best fits the context of each sentence.

delegation	priority	updates	responsibility	follow-up
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1. When delegating tasks, it's essential to set a clear _____ level for each task.
2. When delegating, it's essential to clearly define the _____ of each team member.
3. Effective _____ is crucial for successful project management.
4. Regular _____ from team members help ensure everyone is on track.
5. After delegating tasks, it's crucial to _____ with team members to ensure they're completing tasks as expected.

ACTIVITY 2: PRIORITIZING DELEGATED TASKS

Instructions:

1. **Work in pairs.**
2. **Task List:** Rank the following tasks from **most to least important** based on your ideas:
 - A. Prepare a presentation for a client meeting.
 - B. Complete the monthly budget report.
 - C. Respond to urgent emails from team members.
 - D. Organize the team's resources and materials.
 - E. Conduct a performance review with an employee.
3. **Justify Your Ranking:** After ranking, compare your results with your partner and explain your reasoning using key vocabulary (e.g., urgency, impact, accountability).

4. **Reach a Consensus:** Discuss any differences in your rankings and work together to reach a consensus on the final ranking.
5. **Share with the Class:** If time permits, each pair shares their final ranking and reasoning with the class.



Production

To help you feel more confident and prepared when delegating tasks, answer the following scenario-based questions.

1. You need to delegate a task to a team member. Daniel is busy and Kath is available but inexperienced. To whom do you delegate the task?
2. James isn't completing tasks on time. What do you do to address the issue?
3. You need to delegate a critical task, but no team member has the necessary skills. What do you do?
4. You're managing a remote team; how do you ensure effective communication and task completion?
5. You're delegating a task to a new team member. How do you provide support and guidance?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Delegation	The act of assigning tasks, responsibilities, or authority to others.	<i>The manager's effective delegation of tasks allowed the team to complete the project on time.</i>
Priority	Used in determining which task should be completed first, based on their relative importance and deadlines.	<i>It's essential to clearly communicate the priority level to ensure team members focus on the most critical tasks.</i>
Updates	Refer to the regular communication or reports provided.	<i>The team leader requested regular updates from team members to ensure the project was on track.</i>
Responsibility	The obligation or duty assigned to an individual or team to complete a task, project, or activity.	<i>The team members accepted responsibility for completing the report.</i>
Follow-up	Used in checking or monitoring the progress, status, or completion of tasks and projects assigned to others.	<i>Regular follow-up allowed the team leader to monitor progress and adjust the project plan, as necessary.</i>
I'll take care of...	Used to assign responsibility or ownership of a task or project to oneself or others.	<i>I'll take care of communicating with the client and ensuring their needs are met.</i>
Can you handle this?	Used to assess someone's ability or willingness to take on the task, project, or responsibility.	<i>Can you handle coordinating with the team to get this project started?</i>



Homework

Delegation Exercise

Instructions:

1. Work in pairs.
2. Topic: Organizing a Small Project
3. One person is the “Manager,” and the other is the “Team Member.”
4. The Manager delegates tasks to the Team Member.
5. The Team Member completes the tasks.
6. Time limit is 3-5 minutes audio recording.
7. Submit the recorded presentation.